

The Dance School Awards: Industry Award - Dance School of the Year

Dance School of the Year Application / Nomination Questions.

Please find below 5 questions which we will need you to answer to proceed with your nomination.

Judges will consider:

- Clear, specific achievements from the past year and why they matter.
- Evidence of positive impact on students, staff, or the wider community.
- A clearly articulated ethos and set of values.
- Thoughtful support for students with different goals and pathways.
- Clear safeguarding procedures embedded in everyday practice.
- Awareness of student wellbeing and duty of care.
- Evidence of commitment to equity, diversity, and inclusion in policies, practice, and culture.
- Strong leadership and professional standards.
- A compelling overall case for why the school stands out.

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Blommaert Ballet School

1. Tell us 3 things you are you most proud of your school achieving in the last year. *

1) Creating an inclusive dance school where every student can thrive.

Over the past year, Blommaert Ballet School has continues to strengthen its reputation as a welcoming and nurturing environment where every student feels valued, regardless of age, ability, background or aspirations. Wether a child dances recreationally or is preparing for vocational training or dancing professionally, we tailor our teaching to help every individual reach their potential. Our emphasis on confidence, resilience, and personal growth has resulted in excellent student retention, increased enrolment, and overwhelmingly positive feedback from families and other industry professionals.

2) Delivering exceptional training while prioritising student wellbeing.

We are proud to have maintained exceptionally high teaching standards while ensuring that wellbeing remains at the heart of everything we do. Students have achieved excellent examination, performance and audition outcomes, but equally important has been seeing them develop confidence, discipline, teamwork, and a lifelong love of dance. Safeguarding, pastoral care, and open communication with families are embedded into our daily practice, creating an environment where students feel safe, supported and inspired.

3) Investing in continuous improvement and raising professional standards.

This year has been one of significant professional growth for the school. We have invested in staff development, reflecting on our teaching practice, and continually sought ways to enhance the experience we provide for our students. By embracing innovation while remaining rooted in the highest standards of classical ballet training, Blommaert Ballet School has continued to evolve, ensuring our students receive an outstanding dance education that prepares them not only for success in dance but for life beyond the studio.

2. How would you describe your school's ethos and values? *

At Blommaert Ballet School, our ethos is centred on the belief that dance has the power to transform lives. We are committed to providing exceptional dance education within a supportive, inclusive and inspiring environment where every student is encouraged to achieve their personal best. While we strive for excellence in technical training, we place equal importance on developing confidence, resilience, creativity and a lifelong love for dance.

Our values are built on respect, kindness, integrity and opportunity. Every student is treated as an individual, with teaching tailored to their unique abilities, ambitions and learning styles. Whether a student dreams of a professional dance career or simply wishes to enjoy the benefits of dance, they are equally valued and supported throughout their journey.

Wellbeing and safeguarding are fundamental to everything we do. We work closely with families to ensure every student feels safe, respected, understood and able to flourish both inside and outside the studio. Our culture promotes positive relationships, celebrates diversity and creates a genuine sense of belonging, where every achievement (big or small) is recognised and celebrated.

We are also committed to continuous improvement. Through ongoing professional development and reflective practice, we ensure our teaching remains innovative, engaging and of the highest standard. This commitment enables us to provide outstanding opportunities for our students while maintaining the values that define Blommaert Ballet School: Excellence with compassion, Ambition with humility and Achievement through encouragement.

Ultimately, our aim is not simply to produce skilled dancers, but confident, respectful and resilient young people who carry the lessons they learn in our studios into every aspect of their lives.

3. How do you support both recreational and aspiring professional students? *

At Blommaert Ballet School, we believe that every student's dance journey is equally important. Whether a student attends classes for enjoyment, fitness and confidence, or is working towards a professional career in dance, they receive the same high standard of teaching, encouragement and individual attention.

For our recreational students, we create a positive and inspiring environment where they can develop technical skills while building confidence, friendships and a lifelong love of dance. We celebrate personal progress rather than comparison, ensuring every student experiences success and feels proud of their achievements. Our classes are designed to nurture creativity, resilience and self-belief, helping students develop valuable life skills alongside their dance training.

For students with professional aspirations, we provide structured, high-quality training that prepares them for vocational auditions and further study. This includes personalised guidance, coaching, performance opportunities and honest, constructive feedback to help them reach their full potential. We work closely with students and their families to support their ambitions, while ensuring expectations remain realistic and that wellbeing is never compromised in the pursuit of excellence.

Importantly, there is no divide between our recreational and vocational pathways. Students learn alongside one another or in a private setting in a respectful, inclusive environment where hard work, kindness and commitment are valued above competition. Every child is encouraged to set personal goals, challenge themselves and celebrate the achievements of others.

Our aim is for every student to leave Blommaert Ballet School with confidence, resilience and a sense of belonging. Whether they pursue a career in dance or carry their passion into another field, we want every young person to know they have been supported, inspired and equipped with skills that will benefit them for life.

4. What does safe guarding and student wellbeing look like in practice at your school? *

At Blommaert Ballet School, safeguarding and student wellbeing are not separate initiatives, they underpin every aspect of our culture and daily practice. We believe that children learn best when they feel safe, respected, valued and supported, and we work hard to create an environment where every student can flourish both personally and artistically.

Safeguarding is embedded throughout the school through robust policies, regular staff training and clear procedures that ensure the safety and welfare of every student and our teachers. We maintain open, honest communication with families, encouraging a collaborative approach so that any concerns can be identified and addressed promptly. Our staff understand that safeguarding extends beyond physical safety to include emotional wellbeing, confidence and creating a positive learning environment.

In the studio, we prioritise encouragement over comparison. Our teaching promotes positive body image, resilience and self-belief, recognising that every student develops at their own pace. Constructive feedback is always delivered with kindness and respect, helping students build confidence while striving for excellence. We celebrate effort, progress and personal achievement, ensuring every child feels seen, valued and proud of their journey.

We also recognise that every student is an individual. By taking the time to understand each child's personality, learning style and aspirations, we are able to provide tailored support that helps them succeed. Whether a student is attending for enjoyment or pursuing professional training, their wellbeing always comes first.

Ultimately, our goal is to create more than excellent dancers, we aim to develop confident, resilient and compassionate young people who feel secure, supported and empowered. We are proud that families trust Blommaert Ballet School not only for the quality of our dance education, but for the care, respect and sense of belonging that every student experiences within our community and we are so pleased with the feedback we receive from the families of our students.

5. Why do you believe your school deserves this award? *

Blommaert Ballet School deserves this award because we have created a school where excellence and compassion exist side by side. Our success is not measured solely by audition results or competition achievements, but by the confidence, resilience and sense of belonging that every student gains through their experience with us.

We are proud to offer outstanding dance education in an environment where every child is known, valued and encouraged to reach their full potential. Whether students dance for enjoyment or aspire to a professional career, they receive exceptional teaching, individual support and opportunities to grow in a culture built on respect, kindness and inclusion. Our commitment to safeguarding, wellbeing and personal development is embedded in everything we do, ensuring that students leave our school not only as stronger dancers but as confident, capable young people.

Over the past year, we have continued to raise standards through ongoing professional development, reflective practice and a commitment to continuous improvement. We embrace innovation while remaining true to the values that define our school, ensuring our students receive the highest quality training in a positive and inspiring environment.

What truly sets Blommaert Ballet School apart is our community. We have built a school where students support one another, families feel genuinely connected, and every achievement is celebrated. We believe dance has the power to transform lives, and we are privileged to witness that transformation every day.

Receiving this award would recognise not only the dedication of Sander Blommaert and our teaching team, but also the remarkable commitment, enthusiasm and achievements of our students and families. It would celebrate a school that places people at the heart of everything it does and strives every day to inspire the next generation through outstanding dance education.

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